Qiang (Steven) Wu

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Education

Texas A&M University – Department of Political Science
Ph.D. in Political Science, August 2026, College Station, TX

- Major: **International Relations**
- Minor: **Comparative Politics & Political Methodology**
- **Dissertation:** *Contesting the Liberal Order? Chinese Economic Statecraft, Alternative Institutions, and the Diffusion of Governance Norms*
- **Committee:** Matthew Fuhrmann (Chair), Hyeran Jo (Co-Chair), Matt Malis, David Bearce.

Johns Hopkins University – School of Advanced International Studies (SAIS)
M.A. in International Economics & China Studies, 2020, Washington, DC
Dean's Scholarship, Specialization in Economic Policy

Kyoto University – Graduate School of Economics
M.A. in Economics, 2014, Kyoto, Japan
Japan Development Scholarship (JDS Scholar), fully funded by JICA

Peking University – School of International Studies
M.A. in International Relations, 2012, Beijing, China

Peking University – School of Government
B.A. in Political Science & Public Administration, 2004, Beijing, China

Academic Appointments

University at Albany, SUNY, Adjunct Lecturer in Political Science, August 2026–Present

Research and Teaching Fields

Research: International political economy, economic statecraft, and international institutions, with a focus on China and great-power competition.

Teaching: International political economy; international security; international institutions and development; Chinese politics and foreign policy; U.S.–China relations and Indo-Pacific politics; quantitative methods

Publications and Research in Progress

Job Market Paper

- **Wu, Qiang.** 2026. *"Foreign Aid and Leadership Support in Informal International Institutions: Evidence from China–Africa Cooperation, 2000–2024."* *AidData Working Paper* No. 145. Williamsburg, VA: AidData at William & Mary. Dissertation chapter.
  – Using an original dataset of African delegations to FOCAC meetings (2000–2024), this paper shows that countries receiving more Chinese aid send higher-ranking delegations, and that persistently stronger representation is associated with more Chinese aid in later periods, consistent with a reciprocal exchange of aid for symbolic recognition.
  – Presented: APSA Annual Meeting 2026 (panel organizer); Institute for Humane Studies (IHS) Job Market Papers Workshop 2026

Working Papers

- **Wu, Qiang.** *"Asymmetric Interdependence and Security Reassurance under Great Power Rivalry: China Dependence and U.S.-Involved Joint Military Exercises in the Indo-Pacific, 1992–2016."* Dissertation chapter.
  – Presented: APSA Annual Meeting 2025 (invited panelist), 2024; IHS Trade Papers Workshop (hosted at Harvard University) 2024; MPSA Annual Conference 2023; Cato Institute Junior Scholars Symposium 2023
- **Wu, Qiang.** *"Output Legitimacy Beyond Borders: Does Chinese Development Finance Diffuse Its Model in Africa?"* Dissertation chapter.
  – Presented: IHS Junior Fellows Convening 2026
- **Wu, Qiang**, Kyung Suk Lee, Kirby Goidel, and Clifford Young. "*Income, Populism, Nativism, and Partisanship: How Interests and Ideologies Shape Attitudes Toward Trade and Globalization."*
  – Presented: IHS Contemporary Challenges in Trade Workshops I & II 2025; SPSA Annual Meeting 2023
- **Wu, Qiang** and Quan Li. *"Cold War, Democratization, and the Move to Free Trade in the Developing Countries."*
  – Presented: APSA Annual Meeting 2023; ISA Annual Convention 2023

Other Writing

- **Wu, Qiang.** 2020. "*China's Use of Trade Retaliation in Territorial Disputes: Interdependence with a Difficult but Rational Power."* *SAIS China Studies Review*, Volume 6
- **Wu, Qiang.** 2020. "Time to Retrieve the First Heart of Multilateralism." *The Bretton Woods Committee*.

Fellowships, Honors, and Grants

Fellowships

- **Junior Scholar**, Carnegie International Policy Scholars Consortium and Network (IPSCON), Kissinger Center, Johns Hopkins SAIS, 2024–2025
  – Selected as one of approximately 20 junior scholars
- **Institute for Humane Studies (IHS) Fellowships**: Junior Fellows Program, 2026 ($7,000); Graduate Fellowship, 2025–2026 ($8,000); Humane Studies Fellowship, 2024–2025 ($5,000)
- **Program Fellow**, Foreign Policy Impact Summer Institute (First Cohort of 10 Fellows), Colorado State University, 2025 ($3,000)

Honors

- **First Place**, Business and Political Science Section (Graduate), Student Research Week, Texas A&M University, 2023
- **Second Place**, Henry Owen Memorial Award, Bretton Woods Committee, 2020

Grants

- Research, Methods Training, and Travel Grants, Department of Political Science, Texas A&M University, 2021–2025 ($7,000 in research and training, $6,000 in travel)
- Travel Grant, International Studies Association (ISA), 2024
- Travel Grant, Taiwan-America Conference on Contemporary China, National Chengchi University (Taiwan), 2021

Teaching Experience

Instructor of Record:

University at Albany, SUNY

- RPOS 102: ***Comparative and International Politics*** (Undergraduate, 17 students), Fall 2026
  – Designed group simulations to build teamwork and critical reasoning.
- RINT 507: ***Statistics for International Affairs Managers and Policy Analysts*** (Graduate), Spring 2027 (scheduled)

Texas A&M University

- POLS 429**: *Issues in World Politics*** (Undergraduate, 35 students), Spring 2025 & Fall 2024
  – Designed and taught full course on U.S.–China relations.

Course-Based Undergraduate Research:

- **Founding Editor-in-Chief**, Undergraduate Research Journal on the United States, China, and the World Order, 2024–present
  – Publishes student research from my courses; founded at Texas A&M University (Vol. 1, 2024–2025) and relaunched at the University at Albany, SUNY (2026–present).

Online Teaching:

Education University of Hong Kong

- ***Introduction to Stata,*** *Spring 2022*
  – Designed and delivered an online training bootcamp course for graduate students.

Teaching Assistant:

Johns Hopkins University, SAIS

- SA.553.106: ***Leadership in China*** (Graduate, 45 students, Online), Fall 2026. Prof. Andrew Mertha.
- SA.553.105: ***Contemporary Chinese Politics*** (Graduate, 36 students, Online), Fall 2025. Prof. Andrew Mertha.

Texas A&M University

- POLS 209: ***Political Science Research Methods*** (Undergraduate, 200 students)
  – Designed and led R programming and statistics labs for two sections (25 students each).
  – Worked under Profs. Ali Kagalwala (Spring 2024), Paul Kellstedt (Fall 2023), and Hyeran Jo (Fall 2021).
- POLS 429*:* ***Issues in World Politics*** (Undergraduate, 35 students), Spring 2023
  – Occasionally substituted for Prof. Quan Li.
- POLS 200*:* ***Foundations of Political Science*** (Undergraduate, 200 students)
  – Led discussion for two sections (25 students each).
  – Worked under Profs. José Antonio Cheibub (Spring 2021) and Michelle Taylor-Robinson (Fall 2020).

Research Assistantships

Texas A&M University – Department of Political Science

- Graduate Research Assistant for Prof. Quan Li (Spring 2023, Spring 2022)
  – Supported research on international political economy and education.
- Graduate Research Assistant for Prof. Kirby Goidel (Spring & Fall 2022)
  – Contributed to survey design and analysis on public opinion and trade.

Johns Hopkins University – SAIS, International Political Economy Program

- Graduate Research Assistant for Prof. David Steinberg (Fall 2019)
  – Assisted on project "*Public Responses to Foreign Protectionism: Evidence from the U.S.–China Trade War*."

The U.S.–China Business Council

- Graduate Research Assistant for President Craig Allen (Spring 2019)
  – Researched and drafted materials for book chapter *"U.S.-China Retrospective: Forty Years of Commercial Relations."*

Unirule Institute of Economics, China

- Research Assistant for Prof. Hao Jiang (Spring 2018)
  – Contributed to project *"The Dynamics of Corruption and State–Business Interactions in Chinese Local Governments."*

Professional Experience

National People's Congress (China's national legislature), Foreign Affairs Committee

Policy Aide | Beijing, China | 2014–2017; 2007–2012

- Researched and drafted analyses of foreign-affairs legislation, treaty implementation, and cross-border infrastructure policy.
- Prepared briefing materials on economic and foreign-policy issues for the annual plenary sessions.
- Supported parliamentary exchanges with European and Asia-Pacific legislatures, including outbound and visiting delegations.

Peking University, Academy of e-Government

Project Manager | Beijing, China | 2006–2007

- Led negotiations and institutional coordination with EPFL to establish a collaborative master's program in e-government.

LG Electronics, China Headquarters

Sales & Marketing Executive | Beijing, China | 2004–2006

Professional Development

Research Training

- Mentee, APSA Mentoring Program (Miles Kahler), 2025.
- Inter-University Consortium for Political and Social Research (ICPSR), University of Michigan
  – ***Causal Inference: An SEM Approach*** (Sandy Marquart-Pyatt), 2025
- ***U.S. Foreign Policy Colloquium***, National Committee on U.S.–China Relations, 2019

Teaching Training

- **Faculty Career Fellow Program**, University at Albany, SUNY, 2026-2027
- **CIRTL Associate Fellow Certificate**, Center for the Integration of Research, Teaching, and Learning (CIRTL), Texas A&M University, 2024
- *POLS 681:* ***Teaching Seminar***, Texas A&M University, Spring 2024

Pre-Doctoral Research Presentations

- "Environmental Performance and the Promotion of Local Officials in China," Field Research & Workshop (jointly organized by Kyoto University, Chulalongkorn University, and Thammasat University), Bangkok, Thailand, 2015
- "China: The Way Ahead," Northeast Asia Economic Forum Young Leaders Program (selected as one of approximately 30 fellows from five countries), Seoul & Busan, 2014
- "Management of Agricultural Sector: India, China and Russia," IIDS–IIMS International Conference on Development, University of Bonn, 2014

Service

Conference Service

- **Panel Organizer,** "Economic Statecraft and Rising Power Foreign Policy," APSA Annual Meeting, 2026.
- Discussant, International Studies Association (ISA) Annual Convention, 2023.

University and Department Service

- **Founding Organizer**, Forum on the United States, China, and the World Order, 2024–present: Texas A&M University (2024–2025); relaunched at the University at Albany, SUNY (2026–present)
- **Editor**, SAIS China Studies Review, Johns Hopkins University, School of Advanced International Studies (SAIS), 2018–2019

Professional Memberships

- American Political Science Association (APSA)
- Midwest Political Science Association (MPSA)
- International Studies Association (ISA)

Skills

Methods & Tools

- **Methods:** Causal inference (difference-in-differences including stacked designs, instrumental variables); GIS and spatial analysis (linking geocoded projects to georeferenced survey respondents); structural equation modeling (SEM); multilevel modeling; time-series cross-sectional (TSCS) models with fixed effects; survey experiments
- **Software:** R and Stata (advanced); Python (intermediate)
- **Computational:** Web scraping, corpus construction, and computational text analysis
- **Data Collection Platforms:** Qualtrics and Prolific

Languages

- **Chinese (Mandarin & Cantonese)**: Bilingual